

701–710



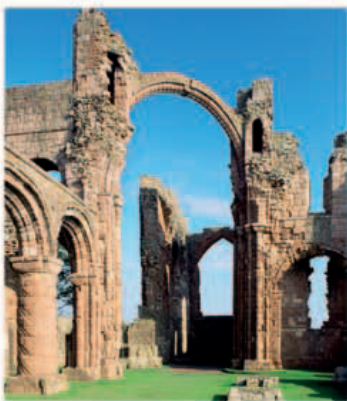
A detail from the illuminated manuscript of the *Lindisfarne Gospels*.

ANGLO-SAXON ART FUSED GERMANIC AND CELTIC ELEMENTS

and, through travelers and Christian pilgrims, it also reflected Roman and Byzantine influences. A product of this unique synthesis was the *Lindisfarne Gospels*, an illuminated manuscript produced c. 701 at the priory of Lindisfarne, on Holy Island, off the northeast coast of England.

In 705, with the help of Bulgar allies, the deposed emperor **Justinian II returned from exile** (see 690–700), regained the Byzantine throne, and exacted brutal revenge on those who had mutilated him.

By 705, **Zoroastrian refugees** fleeing the Islamic conquest of Persia **established communities in India** and became known as the Parsees. Persian Zoroastrian emigration continued during the following centuries.



Ruins of Lindisfarne Priory
The Benedictine Priory, built in the 12th century, replaced an earlier church founded by St. Aidan in 635.

711–720



Greek fire being deployed, as illustrated in the *Madrid Skylitzes* manuscript from the 12th century, which chronicles the history of the Byzantine Empire.



His favorite concubine

This Tang dynasty scroll shows Xuanzong watching his concubine Yang Guifei mount a horse. The emperor's love for her inspired much drama and poetry.

IN 710, THE VISIGOTHIC KINGDOM OF SPAIN had descended into civil war, presenting a tempting prospect to the Islamic armies now established in North Africa, just a short distance away across the Straits of Gibraltar. In 711, a Muslim army under general **Tariq ibn Ziyad**, landed at Gibraltar. Tariq was a Berber (native of northwestern Africa), or, in the parlance of the times, a Moor, and it was a mixed army of Arabs and Moors that achieved the **conquest of Spain**, known to the Islamic world as **al-Andalus**. According to tradition, Tariq defeated the Visigothic king, Roderick, at the Battle of Guadalete, and by the end of the year most of the Iberian peninsula was under Islamic control. Only the northwest, known as **Asturias**, managed to

resist the invaders, with defeat at the Battle of Covadonga in 718 checking the Arab advance. The year 718 is one of the dates traditionally given for the start of the process of Christian reconquest of Spain. Nonetheless, by the end of the decade further expeditions across the Pyrenees, and successful campaigns in Central Asia, had **extended**

GREEK FIRE

The Arab expansion indirectly proved the savior of the Byzantine Empire, when Kallinikos, a Syrian Greek forced into exile by the Arab invasion, brought to Constantinople the recipe for a secret weapon that came to be known as Greek fire. Now believed to have been a concoction of naphtha, sulfur, quicklime, and nitre—a sort of medieval napalm—this highly flammable mixture was sprayed at enemies from a siphon device that could be fitted to the prow of a Byzantine war galley.

721–730



An iconic image of Christ held by Necessarius, Patriarch of Constantinople.

CASA GRANDE FLOURISHED AROUND THE 720s

The success of this settlement of the Hohokam, an ancient people of the Sonoran desert in modern-day Arizona, lay in a watering system that allowed a range of crops to be grown, despite the arid environment. The Hohokam lived here for more than a millennium; they were known as **"canal builders"** because of their sophisticated irrigation technology. Casa Grande was at the **center of a trade network** that stretched from the **Pacific** coast to Tucson and to the **Gulf of Mexico**. The earliest structures at Casa Grande were probably pit houses; the "great house" that gives the site its name came much later.

In 725, the **Khazars**, a Turkic people of Central Asian origin, **established their capital at Atil**, on the Volga delta at the northwestern corner of the Caspian Sea. From here they **controlled trade routes to all corners of Asia** and built an empire that would control a huge swathe of Eastern Europe and Western Asia for centuries to come.

In Byzantium in 726, the emperor Leo III (see 711–20) instituted a **policy of iconoclasm** (smashing images deemed sacrilegious) in response to the idea that God was punishing Christian Byzantines by their loss of land to the Arabs and Slavs. The controversy encouraged the Roman papacy to assert their independence from Byzantine imperial authority.

c. 701 Creation of the *Lindisfarne Gospels*
705 Empress Wu deposed, dies
705 Justinian II returns from exile and massacres opponents
705 Parsees (Persian Zoroastrians fleeing Islamic expansion) established in India

710 Islamic conquest of Sind (in Pakistan) under Mohammed ibn al-Kasim (to 715)
711 Islamic army under Tariq ibn Ziyad invades Spain
711 Justinian II killed by rebels
712 Liutprand, king of the Lombards, attempts rule the Lombard kingdom reaches its height

713 Xuanzong becomes emperor in China
714 Charles Martel becomes ruler of the Frankish kingdom
716 Islamic forces take Lisbon
717–18 Second Siege of Constantinople: use of "Greek fire" halts Arab expansion in Eastern Mediterranean

720 Arabs occupy Provence: caliphate extends from Pyrenees to China
721 Arabs checked by duke Eudo at the Battle of Toulouse
725 De Temporum Ratione, a work by the English monk Bede, popularizes the AD/BC system of dating

c. 725 Hohokam settlement of Casa Grande in Arizona founded
726 Iconoclasm in Byzantium: the emperor Leo uses policy to oppose growth of monastic power